🐧 Basic Linux Commands Notes

Below are **30 essential Linux commands** explained with **syntax** and **examples** to help you understand their usage clearly.

1. pwd – Print Working Directory

Syntax: pwd
Example:

$ pwd

/home/deva

Displays the current directory path

2. ls – List Directory Contents

Syntax: ls [options] [directory]
Example:

$ ls -l

Lists files with details (permissions, size, etc.).

3. cd – Change Directory

Syntax: cd [directory]
Example:

$ cd Documents

Moves to the Documents directory

4. mkdir – Make Directory

Syntax: mkdir [directory_name]
Example:

$ mkdir projects

Creates a new directory named *projects*

5. rmdir – Remove Empty Directory

Syntax: rmdir [directory_name]
Example:

$ rmdir old_folder

Deletes an empty directory

6. touch – Create an Empty File

Syntax: touch [filename]
Example:

$ touch notes.txt

Creates a new empty file named *notes.txt*.

7. cp – Copy Files or Directories

Syntax: cp [source] [destination]
Example:

$ cp file1.txt backup/

Copies *file1.txt* into *backup/* folder.

8. mv – Move or Rename Files

Syntax: mv [source] [destination]
Example:

$ mv oldname.txt newname.txt

Renames a file.

9. rm – Remove Files or Directories

Syntax: rm [options] [file]
Example:

$ rm file.txt

Deletes the file *file.txt*.

10. cat – Display File Content

Syntax: cat [filename]
Example:

$ cat notes.txt

Shows the content of *notes.txt*.

11. head – Show Beginning of a File

Syntax: head [filename]
Example:

$ head -5 data.txt

Shows the first 5 lines of *data.txt*.

12. tail – Show End of a File

Syntax: tail [filename]
Example:

$ tail -3 log.txt

Shows the last 3 lines of *log.txt*.

13. echo – Print Message or Variable

Syntax: echo [string]
Example:

$ echo "Hello Linux!"

Displays the text *Hello Linux!*.

14. clear – Clear the Terminal

Syntax: clear
Example:

$ clear

Clears all text in the terminal.

15. man – Show Manual Page

Syntax: man [command]
Example:

$ man ls

Shows detailed documentation for the *ls* command.

16. history – Show Command History

Syntax: history
Example:

$ history

Displays previously executed commands.

17. whoami – Display Current Username

Syntax: whoami
Example:

$ whoami

deva

Prints the logged-in user name.

18. uname – Show System Information

Syntax: uname [options]
Example:

$ uname -a

Displays kernel and system details.

19. date – Display or Set Date and Time

Syntax: date [options]
Example:

$ date

Thu Oct 16 20:30:45 IST 2025

Shows the current date and time.

20. cal – Display Calendar

Syntax: cal [month] [year]
Example:

$ cal 10 2025

Displays the calendar of October 2025.

21. df – Display Disk Space Usage

Syntax: df [options]
Example:

$ df -h

Shows disk usage in human-readable format

22. du – Display Directory Space Usage

Syntax: du [options] [directory]
Example:

$ du -sh Documents/

Displays total space used by the *Documents* folder.

23. ps – D

isplay Running Processes

Syntax: ps [options]
Example:

$ ps aux

Shows a list of active processes.

24. top – Real-Time Process Viewer

Syntax: top
Example:

$ top

Shows live system resource usage.

25. kill – Terminate a Process

Syntax: kill [PID]
Example:

$ kill 1234

Kills the process with ID *1234*.

26. ping – Check Network Connectivity

Syntax: ping [hostname or IP]
Example:

$ ping google.com

Sends packets to check internet connectivity.

27. ifconfig / ip – Display Network Configuration

Syntax: ifconfig or ip a
Example:

$ ip a

Shows all network interfaces and IP addresses.

28. chmod – Change File Permissions

Syntax: chmod [permissions] [filename]
Example:

$ chmod 755 script.sh

Grants read, write, and execute permissions to the owner.

29. chown – Change File Ownership

Syntax: chown [owner]:[group] [filename]
Example:

$ chown deva:users report.txt

Changes file owner to *deva* and group to *users*.

30. sudo – Execute Command as Superuser

Syntax: sudo [command]
Example:

$ sudo apt update

Runs the command with administrative privileges.

- **Summary**

These 30 commands cover basic file handling, system monitoring, and user administration essential for beginners to navigate and control a Linux system effectively.